



**CYBERSECURITY
UMBRELLA**

NEWSLETTER

CYBERSECURITY UMBRELLA

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Darcula 3.0: The Next Wave of Phishing Attacks

Type of Attack
Phishing Attack

Overview

- A new version of the Darcula phishing-as-a-service (PhaaS) platform is being developed, making it even easier for cybercriminals to create phishing websites.
- This updated version allows **users to clone any brand's website quickly**, reducing the **technical skills** needed to carry out phishing attacks on a large scale.

How It Works?

- 01** Users enter the URL of the brand they want to impersonate.
- 02** The platform uses automation tools to copy the brand's website layout and assets.
- 03** Cybercriminals replace certain elements (such as login or payment fields) with fraudulent ones.
- 04** The phishing page is uploaded to an admin panel, where criminals manage their campaigns

Who does it target the most?

*"It primarily targets **consumers** rather than **businesses**"*

Focusing on **postal services** like Kuwait Post, UAE's Etisalat, Jordan Post, Saudi Post, Australia Post, and others.

Key Statistics

(as of March 2024 – January 2025)

20,000+ fraudulent websites taken down	31,000+ malicious IP addresses identified
95,000+ new Darcula phishing domains detected and blocked	

Additional Features

- **Admin Panel & Dashboards:** Provides fraudsters with tools to **manage phishing campaigns, track statistics**, and access stolen data.
- **Credit Card Fraud:** Converts stolen credit card details into **virtual cards** that can be added to **digital wallets** and used illegally. Faster Phishing Kit.

Bybit's \$1.5 Billion Crypto Heist: How Hackers Outsmarted Security

Type of Attack
Smart Contract Exploitation

Overview

In February 2025, cryptocurrency exchange Bybit suffered a massive cyberattack, resulting in the theft of over \$1.5 billion worth of Ethereum (ETH) from its cold wallet. This attack, linked to the North Korea-based Lazarus Group, is the largest crypto heist in history.

How it happened?

- Bybit was conducting a **routine transfer of ETH** from its cold wallet to its hot wallet when the attackers manipulated the transaction.
- They **altered** the **smart contract logic** and masked the **signing interface**, making it appear that the funds were being transferred securely.
- Instead, the hackers gained control of the wallet and **redirected** the funds to an **unknown address**.



Over **400,000 ETH** and stETH
worth
more than **\$1.5 billion** were
transferred

Past Crypto Heists

Bybit's hack surpasses previous major crypto thefts:



\$611 million stolen
Poly Network (2021)



\$624 million stolen
Ronin Network (2022)



\$586 million stolen
BNB Bridge (2022)

Understanding Cold and Hot Wallets

- Cold Wallet:** A highly secure, offline storage method for cryptocurrencies, used to protect assets from online threats.
- Hot Wallet:** A connected, online wallet used for quick transactions, but it carries higher security risks.
- Smart Contract Logic:** Refers to the predefined rules and conditions programmed into blockchain-based contracts. These contracts automatically execute transactions when conditions are met.

DeceptiveDevelopment Malware Campaign

Type of Attack
Social Engineering Campaign

The DeceptiveDevelopment campaign, represents a sophisticated North Korean cyber threat targeting **freelance software developers**. The attackers leveraged fake job opportunities to distribute malware, aiming to steal **cryptocurrency, credentials, and deploy backdoors** for further exploitation.

How hackers Perform This Campaign?

Platforms Targeted

01 INITIAL CONTACT:

Attackers posed as **software development recruiters** on job platforms such as LinkedIn, Upwork, Freelancer.com, We Work Remotely, Moonlight, and Crypto Jobs List.

02 SOCIAL ENGINEERING

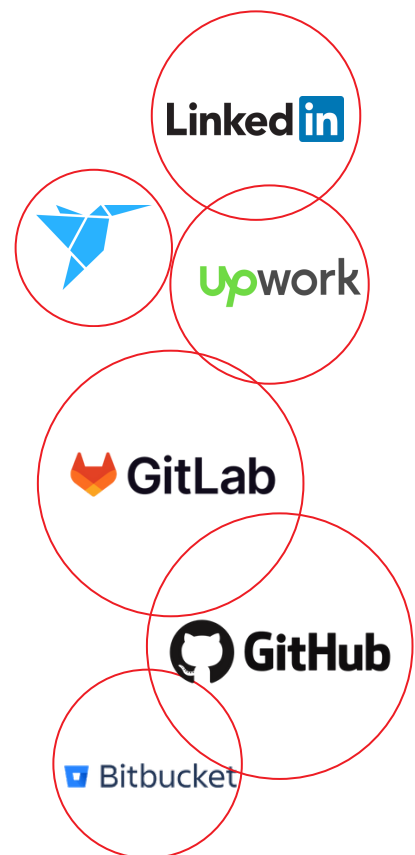
Victims, primarily **English-speaking** developers in the cryptocurrency and DeFi sectors, were lured with fake job offers.

03 MALICIOUS CODE INJECTION

Attackers provided victims with software projects via file transfers or private repositories on platforms like **GitHub, GitLab, and Bitbucket**.

04 EXECUTION AND INFECTION

Victims were instructed to **compile and execute** the project, unknowingly deploying BeaverTail malware, which subsequently installed InvisibleFerret spyware.



Case Study: Ransomware Attack on Lee Enterprises

Type of Attack
Ransomware Attack

Overview

Lee Enterprises, a major **American** media company that owns **350 publications across 25 states**, recently suffered a ransomware attack. The incident caused significant disruptions to newspaper distribution, subscription accounts, and internal operations. The company is currently investigating the extent of the data breach and financial impact.

What Happened?

- On February 3, 2025, Lee Enterprises experienced a **technology outage** due to a cyberattack.
- Threat actors accessed the **company's network, encrypted critical applications, and exfiltrated data**, consistent with a ransomware attack.
- The attack disrupted newspaper printing, billing, collections, and vendor payments, affecting at least **75 publications**.
- By February 12, 2025, most core products were restored, but some weekly and specialty publications remained unavailable.
- Lee Enterprises is conducting a forensic investigation to determine if personal data was compromised.
- The company has a cybersecurity insurance policy to cover incident response costs, but the full financial impact is still being assessed.

